and the chromosomes becomes uncoiled. Nucleolus reappears.

In plants after karyokinesis, cytokinesis takes place by which two daughter cells are formed by the cell plate between 2 groups of chromosomes known as **dyad of cells (haploid)**.

The stage between the two meiotic divisions is called **interkinesis** which is short-lived.

Meiosis II – Equational division.

This division is otherwise called **mitotic meiosis** because it resembles mitosis. Since it includes all the stages of mitotic divisions.

Prophase II

The chromosome with 2 chromatids becomes short, condensed, thick and becomes visible. New spindle develops at right angles to the cell axis. Nuclear membrane and nucleolus disappear.

Metaphase II

Chromosome arranged at the equatorial plane of the spindle. Microtubules of spindle gets attached to the centromere of sister chromatids.

Anaphase II

Sister chromatids separate. The daughter chromosomes move to the opposite poles due to shortening of spindle fibres. Centromere of each chromosome split, allowing to move towards opposite poles of the cells holding the sister chromatids.

Telophase II

Four groups of chromosomes are organised into four haploid nuclei. The spindle disappears. Nuclear envelope, nucleolus reappear.

After karyokinesis, cytokinesis follows and four haploid daughter cells are formed, called **tetrads**.

7.3.7 Significance of Meiosis

- This maintains a definite constant number of chromosomes in organisms.
- Crossing over takes place and exchange of genetic material leads to variations among species. These variations are the raw materials to evolution. Meiosis leads to genetic variability by partitioning different combinations of genes into gametes through independent assortment.
- Adaptation of organisms to various environmental stress.

Table 7.3: Difference between mitosis in Plants and Animals

Plants	Animals
Centrioles are absent	Centrioles are present
Asters are not formed	Asters are formed
Cell division involves the formation of a cell plate	Cell division involves furrowing and cleavage of cytoplasm
Occurs mainly at meristem	Occurs in tissues throughout the body

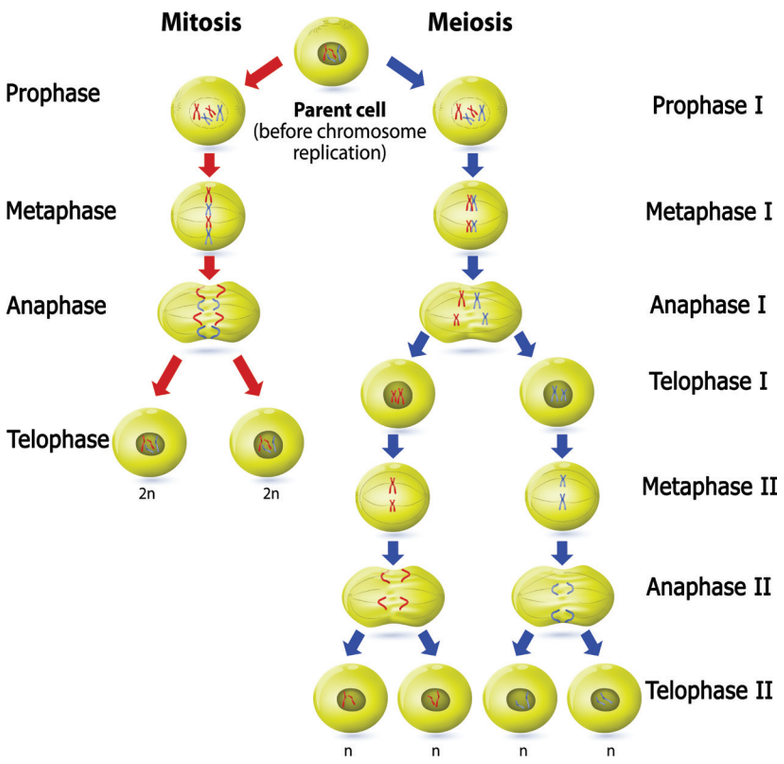


Figure 7.8: Meiosis

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